

PULP GOVERNANCE

Past, Present and Future

Roadmap

- What is governance?
- How Pulp works today
- Where we could go

Self-Presentation

- Software engineer at Red Hat
- Working full time on Pulp
- Supervised by two cats

Cat supervisors



Disclaimer

- I'm still learning about governance
- I hope these ideas spark useful discussion

Open-Source and Governance

What is governance?

A definition

(...) a system of **rules, roles, and procedures** *that determine how* **power** *in an organization gets distributed.*

The Open Source Way

Who belongs to the project?

- Developers
- Users
- Companies

Five models

- Do-ocracy
- Founder-leader
- Electoral
- Single-vendor
- Foundation-backed

Do-ocracy

- Those doing the work make decisions
- Trust grows through contribution
- Often small, informal projects

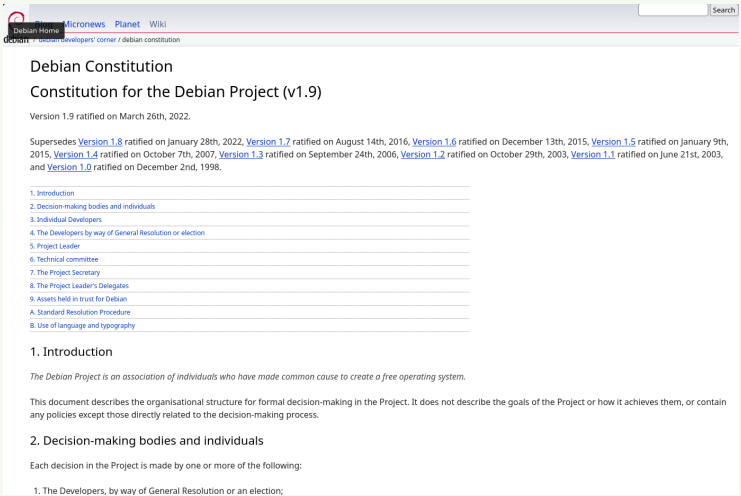
Founder-leader

- Founder has the final say
- Python: Guido van Rossum
- Un-tie hard decisions rapidly

Electoral

- Members elect leaders
- Debian: Project Leader
- Developers vote on general resolutions

Debian constitution

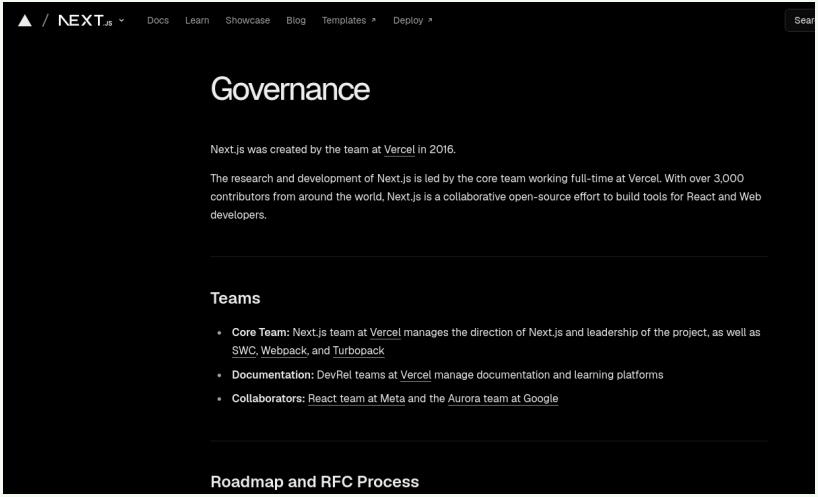


Debian Constitution

Single-vendor

- One company leads development
- Next.js: Vercel's core team
- Outside contributors participate

Next.js governance

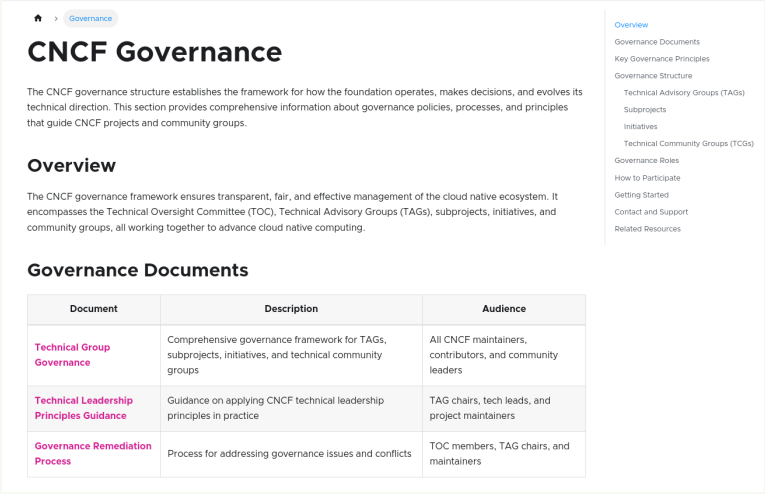


Next.js governance

Foundation-backed

- Shared standards and resources
- CNCF: project governance requirements
- Diversity across organizations

CNCF governance



Governance

CNCF Governance

The CNCF governance structure establishes the framework for how the foundation operates, makes decisions, and evolves its technical direction. This section provides comprehensive information about governance policies, processes, and principles that guide CNCF projects and community groups.

Overview

The CNCF governance framework ensures transparent, fair, and effective management of the cloud native ecosystem. It encompasses the Technical Oversight Committee (TOC), Technical Advisory Groups (TAGs), subprojects, initiatives, and community groups, all working together to advance cloud native computing.

Governance Documents

Document	Description	Audience
Technical Group Governance	Comprehensive governance framework for TAGs, subprojects, initiatives, and technical community groups	All CNCF maintainers, contributors, and community leaders
Technical Leadership Principles Guidance	Guidance on applying CNCF technical leadership principles in practice	TAG chairs, tech leads, and project maintainers
Governance Remediation Process	Process for addressing governance issues and conflicts	TOC members, TAG chairs, and maintainers

Overview
Governance Documents
Key Governance Principles
Governance Structure
Technical Advisory Groups (TAGs)
Subprojects
Initiatives
Technical Community Groups (TCGs)
Governance Roles
How to Participate
Getting Started
Contact and Support
Related Resources

CNCF governance

And Pulp?

And Pulp?

- Red Hat is central
- Other companies contribute
- Users and individuals matter

Our question

How can we understand and shape our governance to maximize the value of this piece of software, which plays such an important role in todays tech industry?

Recap

- Rules, roles, and procedures distribute power
- Five governance models
- Full community potential

Governance in Pulp

Closer look



Image: freefoodphotos.com (Creative Commons Attribution)

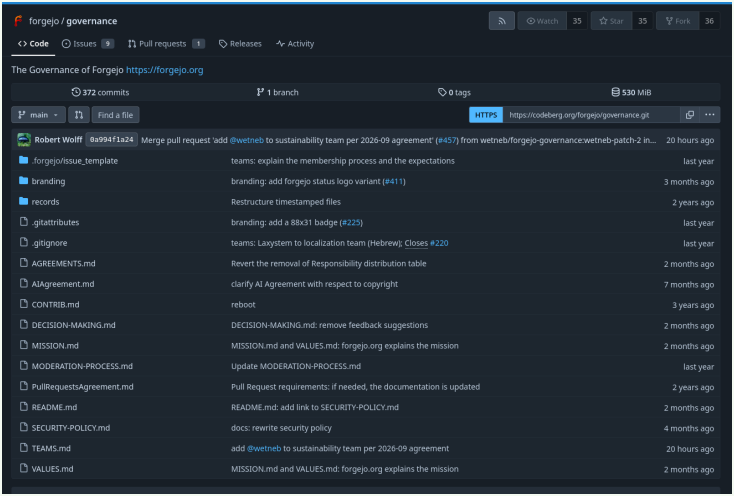
Rules / Existing State

- Code of Conduct
- Privacy and licensing
- Contribution guidelines

Rules / What's new

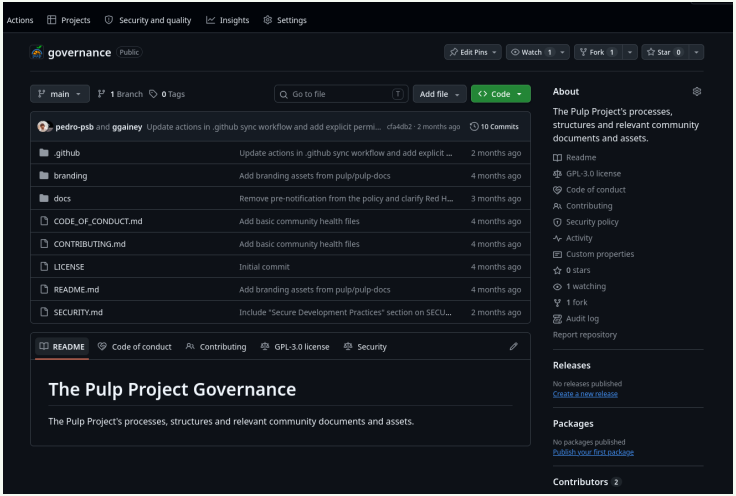
- AI Policy
- `pulp/governance`
- A shared source of truth

Rules / Forgejo inspiration



Forgejo governance repository

Rules / Pulp governance repository



Pulp governance repository

Rules / Opportunities

- Consolidate project-wide rules
- Define room for local rules
- Keep required files in sync

Roles / Existing State

- GitHub teams encode permissions
- Maintainers and plugin leaders
- Some roles remain implicit

Roles / What's new

- BDFL: Grant Gainey
- Help resolve greater technical and political conflicts

Roles / What's new

- Tech Lead: Grant Gainey
- Help resolve greater technical and political conflicts

Roles / Opportunities

- `MAINTAINERS.md` per project
- Clear ownership
- Easier to spot coverage gaps

Roles / Company users

- Public interest in specific projects
- Private direct contact
- Recognition with permission

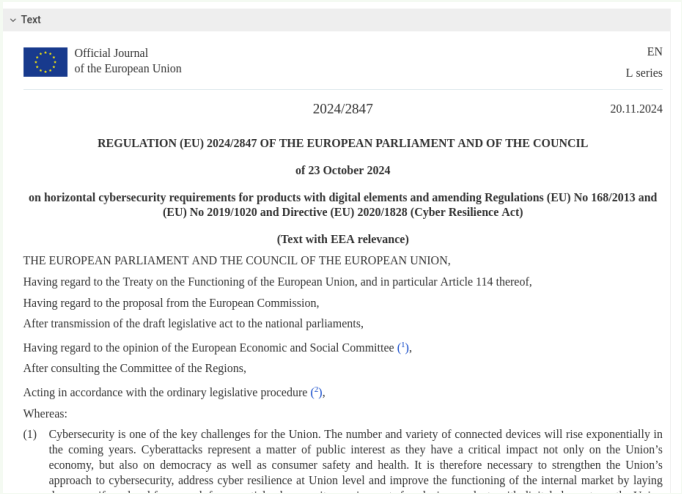
Processes / Existing State

- Open meetings
- Bug triage
- Release and meeting rotations

- Pulp in Red Hat's Light Stewardship program for CRA

- European Cyber Resilience Act (CRA)
- Cybersecurity requirements for products with digital elements

Processes / CRA text



Text

Official Journal
of the European Union

EN
L series

2024/2847

20.11.2024

REGULATION (EU) 2024/2847 OF THE EUROPEAN PARLIAMENT AND OF THE COUNCIL

of 23 October 2024

on horizontal cybersecurity requirements for products with digital elements and amending Regulations (EU) No 168/2013 and (EU) No 2019/1020 and Directive (EU) 2020/1828 (Cyber Resilience Act)

(Text with EEA relevance)

THE EUROPEAN PARLIAMENT AND THE COUNCIL OF THE EUROPEAN UNION,

Having regard to the Treaty on the Functioning of the European Union, and in particular Article 114 thereof,

Having regard to the proposal from the European Commission,

After transmission of the draft legislative act to the national parliaments,

Having regard to the opinion of the European Economic and Social Committee [1],

After consulting the Committee of the Regions,

Acting in accordance with the ordinary legislative procedure [2],

Whereas:

(1) Cybersecurity is one of the key challenges for the Union. The number and variety of connected devices will rise exponentially in the coming years. Cyberattacks represent a matter of public interest as they have a critical impact not only on the Union's economy, but also on democracy as well as consumer safety and health. It is therefore necessary to strengthen the Union's approach to cybersecurity, address cyber resilience at Union level and improve the functioning of the internal market by laying

EUR-Lex, Regulation (EU) 2024/2847

Processes / Red Hat stewardship

- Light: policies and processes
- Champion: additional standards
- Pulp starts with Light

Processes / Pulp working group

- Andrew, Matthias, Grant, Pedro
- Security Policy
- Vulnerability Management Policy
- `SECURITY.md`

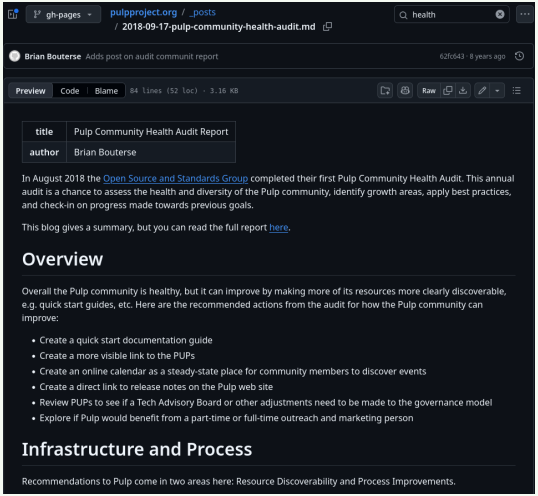
Processes / Complementary efforts

CRA work $\longleftrightarrow$ `pulp/governance`

Processes / Opportunities

- Make audits regular
- Follow up on findings

Processes / 2018 community audit



gh-pages · pulpproject.org / _posts / 2018-09-17-pulp-community-health-audit.md · health

Brian Bouterse Adds post on audit communit report · 62fc643 · 8 years ago

Preview | Code | Blame · 84 lines (52 loc) · 3.16 KB · Raw

title	Pulp Community Health Audit Report
author	Brian Bouterse

In August 2018 the Open Source and Standards Group completed their first Pulp Community Health Audit. This annual audit is a chance to assess the health and diversity of the Pulp community, identify growth areas, apply best practices, and check-in on progress made towards previous goals.

This blog gives a summary, but you can read the full report here.

Overview

Overall the Pulp community is healthy, but it can improve by making more of its resources more clearly discoverable, e.g. quick start guides, etc. Here are the recommended actions from the audit for how the Pulp community can improve:

- Create a quick start documentation guide
- Create a more visible link to the PUPs
- Create an online calendar as a steady-state place for community members to discover events
- Create a direct link to release notes on the Pulp web site
- Review PUPs to see if a Tech Advisory Board or other adjustments need to be made to the governance model
- Explore if Pulp would benefit from a part-time or full-time outreach and marketing person

Infrastructure and Process

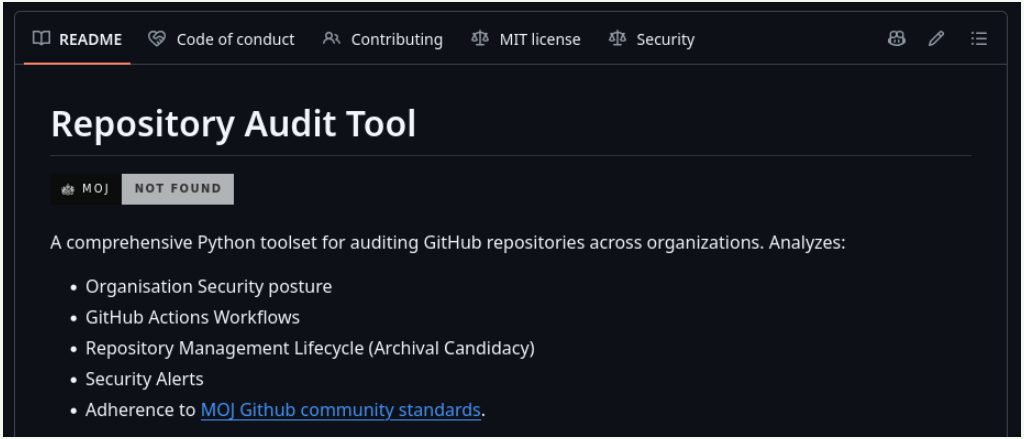
Recommendations to Pulp come in two areas here: Resource Discoverability and Process Improvements.

Pulp Community Health Audit Report

Processes / Repeatable checks

- Component health
- Maintainer coverage
- Security practices

Processes / MoJ audit tool



UK Ministry of Justice Repository Audit Tool

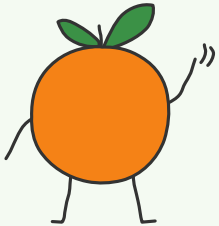
Processes / Company user relationships

- Regular contact
- Early notice of maintenance gaps
- A path to new ownership

Governance in Pulp / Recap

- Rules: `pulp/governance`
- Roles: room to improve
- Processes: project and community health

The End



“Thanks! Questions?”